

Parent Guide — primary / module-10-herbs-aushadhi

IKS Curriculum

Table of Contents

Parent Guide — Herbs — Auṣadhi (Primary)

What is your child learning?

Six widely-available herbs — Tulsī, Neem, Turmeric, Ginger, Ajwain, Mint — studied through botanical identification, traditional uses from Āyurveda, modern phytochemistry (active compounds), and safety. The module emphasises that kitchen amounts are safe, but therapeutic doses require a qualified practitioner.

Why this matters

This module is part of an Indian Knowledge Systems curriculum that introduces classical Indian frameworks alongside their modern-scientific parallels. Your child will learn to (a) name and use precise Sanskrit terms, (b) understand the observational basis for the classical framework, and (c) relate it to current scientific or scholarly understanding.

What you can do at home

Many of these herbs are in your kitchen already. Help your child by letting them touch, smell, and learn to identify them in your home. **IMPORTANT:** this module teaches identification and traditional uses — not self-medication. Consult a doctor for any health concern.

Conversation prompts

Try one of these over a meal or walk:

1. “What’s one Sanskrit word you learned this week? What does it mean?”
2. “What did you find surprising in this module?”
3. “Is there anything you’re not sure about? Let’s look it up together.”
4. “How would you explain this to your grandmother / grandfather?”

Questions parents often ask

Q: Is this religious instruction? A: No. The module presents Indian classical frameworks (cosmology, mathematics, astronomy, ecology) as historical knowledge systems with their own logic and method. The framing is scholarly and comparative, not devotional.

Q: Will my child be tested on Sanskrit? A: Sanskrit terms are introduced for precision, not for rote memorisation. The summative quiz asks students to *use* the terms — for example, “Which doṣa is dominant in the morning hours?” — rather than translate them.

Q: How does this connect to NCERT / board syllabus? A: This module supplements (does not replace) NCERT content. NEP 2020 §4.6 calls for the integration of Indian Knowledge Systems. The pack’s README.md lists the specific NEP principles each module advances.

Reading further (for parents)

See sources.md in this pack for the full source list.

10-Day Lesson Plan

Lesson Plan — Herbs — Auṣadhi (Primary)

10-day arc, 30 min per session.

Day 1 — What is Auṣadhi?

Objective: Define auṣadhi and recognise the six herbs of this module.

Flow: Warm-up (5 min) · Core (15 min) · Activity (8 min) · Wrap-up (5 min)

Day 2 — Tulsī — Holy Basil

Objective: Identify tulasī by leaf and smell; name the active compound (eugenol).

Flow: Warm-up (5 min) · Core (15 min) · Activity (8 min) · Wrap-up (5 min)

Day 3 — Neem — Bitter Healer

Objective: Identify nimba; learn about azadirachtin; understand high-dose safety warning.

Flow: Warm-up (5 min) · Core (15 min) · Activity (8 min) · Wrap-up (5 min)

Day 4 — Turmeric — Golden Root

Objective: Distinguish fresh root vs powder; identify curcumin as active compound.

Flow: Warm-up (5 min) · Core (15 min) · Activity (8 min) · Wrap-up (5 min)

Day 5 — Ginger — Warming Root

Objective: Distinguish fresh vs dried; gingerol vs shogaol.

Flow: Warm-up (5 min) · Core (15 min) · Activity (8 min) · Wrap-up (5 min)

Day 6 — Ajwain — Carom Seed

Objective: Recognise seeds and leaves; identify thymol; traditional digestive use.

Flow: Warm-up (5 min) · Core (15 min) · Activity (8 min) · Wrap-up (5 min)

Day 7 — Mint — Cooling Leaf

Objective: Recognise several Mentha varieties; identify menthol.

Flow: Warm-up (5 min) · Core (15 min) · Activity (8 min) · Wrap-up (5 min)

Day 8 — Herbs and the Doṣas

Objective: Categorise the six herbs by heating/cooling effect (links to Module 4).

Flow: Warm-up (5 min) · Core (15 min) · Activity (8 min) · Wrap-up (5 min)

Day 9 — Build the Class Deck

Objective: Each student contributes one identification card to the class library.

Flow: Warm-up (5 min) · Core (15 min) · Activity (8 min) · Wrap-up (5 min)

Day 10 — Final Share and Assessment

Objective: Present the class herb deck; take summative quiz.

Flow: Warm-up (5 min) · Core (15 min) · Activity (8 min) · Wrap-up (5 min)

Pacing notes

- Primary sessions are 30 min. Adjust if your block is different.
- Days 5 and 9 are buffer days — use to reinforce weaker concepts or extend stronger ones.
- The summative project (see [assessments/project-brief.md](#)) runs in parallel from Day 6 onward.

Differentiation

- **For advanced students:** see [teacher-notes.md](#) for extension prompts.
- **For students needing more support:** simplify activities, do more pair-work, allow oral instead of written responses.

Homework

Homework — Herbs — Auṣadhi (Primary)

Light daily tasks. Each takes 5–10 minutes.

1. **Day 1 — What is Auṣadhi?** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)

2. **Day 2 — Tulsī — Holy Basil** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
3. **Day 3 — Neem — Bitter Healer** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
4. **Day 4 — Turmeric — Golden Root** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
5. **Day 5 — Ginger — Warming Root** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
6. **Day 6 — Ajwain — Carom Seed** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
7. **Day 7 — Mint — Cooling Leaf** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
8. **Day 8 — Herbs and the Doṣas** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
9. **Day 9 — Build the Class Deck** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
10. **Day 10 — Final Share and Assessment** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)

Notes

- Homework is intended to consolidate what was learned in class, not introduce new content.
- If a child struggles, the parent should consult the teacher rather than push.
- Capstone project days (Module 15) may have lighter daily homework so students can focus on the project.